

# Finwise

## Iteration 2 - Review & Retrospect

\* When: March 8, 2026

\* Where: ONLINE

### Process - Reflection

(Optional) Short introduction

FinWise is a Canadian-focused AI financial agent designed to give users personalized, practical guidance based on *their* real situation. Users can either log in or continue as a guest, then build a profile through a short questionnaire (income, goals, risk tolerance, etc.) and optionally add their investment portfolio (stocks, ETFs, mutual funds). Using these two sources of information, your personal profile and your holdings, FinWise tailors its responses and explanations to you, and supports recommendations by searching trusted, authoritative articles so the answers are grounded and transparent.

## Decisions that turned out well

### 1.Strategic Sprint Segmentation for Mutual Funds & ETFs

We split Mutual Funds and ETFs into separate sprints to allow for better focus. This sprint prioritized Mutual Funds, enabling each team member to develop a deeper understanding of the asset class and contribute relevant mutual funds and articles to our database infrastructure.

### 2. Vector Database Implementation for Article Storage

To optimize information retrieval, we implemented a vector database to store chunked and tokenized article content. This approach improves search efficiency and relevance compared to storing raw text articles in MongoDB.

### 3. Improved UI Consistency & Design

We enhanced the visual consistency and user experience across the platform, including the homepage, login page, and profile/portfolio pages, resulting in a more polished and cohesive interface.

### 4. Prompt engineering pipeline

Established the prompt building pipeline using the established knowledge (investment articles) databases and mutual funds info. Use similarity vector search for most relevant chunk (top 5) to save token and ensure relativity. Used pre-screening mutual fund data filtering (choose only the

funds with risk under the user's risk tolerance and those that have a minimal investment amount less than the user's savings) to ensure customization and to safe token.

## **Decisions that did not turn out as well as we hoped**

### **1.Canadian Mutual Funds Data Sourcing**

We initially underestimated the complexity of acquiring comprehensive mutual fund data. After discovering that no free API provides complete coverage of Canadian mutual funds, we faced two options: either manually research and hardcode fund information (extremely labor-intensive) or find alternative solutions. This highlighted the importance of early API research and data availability assessment.

### **2.AI Model Selection & Limitations**

We transitioned from Perplexity AI to Claude after policy changes made Perplexity unsuitable for our use case. Additionally, Perplexity's inability to process image inputs conflicted with our requirements, making Claude the more appropriate choice moving forward.

## **Planned changes**

None

## **Product - Review**

### **Goals and/or tasks that were met/completed:**

Refer to the release plan:

- Researched and curated articles related to mutual funds
- Implemented a vector database to store, chunk, and embed mutual fund articles for semantic search
- Developed web scraping solutions to collect mutual fund data(temporarily)
- Implemented email/password authentication with email verification functionality
- Enhanced the profile interface with expanded questionnaire content
- Enhanced portfolio interface with expanded mutual funds options

## **Goals and/or tasks that were planned but not met/completed:**

### **Plaid connection**

Due to an unforeseen capacity change, the feature could not be completed as planned; the application of the plaid api remains to be discovered and discussed more. Currently, only the frontend (visual representation) is built; functionality will be wired in later sprints.

## **Meeting Highlights**

Going into the next iteration, our main insights are:

### **1. Expand Asset Coverage to ETFs**

Research and integrate ETF data sources, including identifying reliable APIs for ETF information. Process and embed ETF data into the vector database alongside mutual fund content, enabling the AI agent to provide comprehensive recommendations across both asset classes.

### **2. Enhance Knowledge Base Quality**

Conduct deeper research to identify and integrate non-biased, authoritative articles and sources into the knowledge base. Prioritize editorial quality and financial accuracy to further reduce potential bias in AI responses.

### **3. Complete “connect to Plaid functionality.”**

Wire the established frontend with actual functionality using the Plaid API. Investigate more on how this newly-complted functionality can be integrated into the existing AI-chat pipeline.